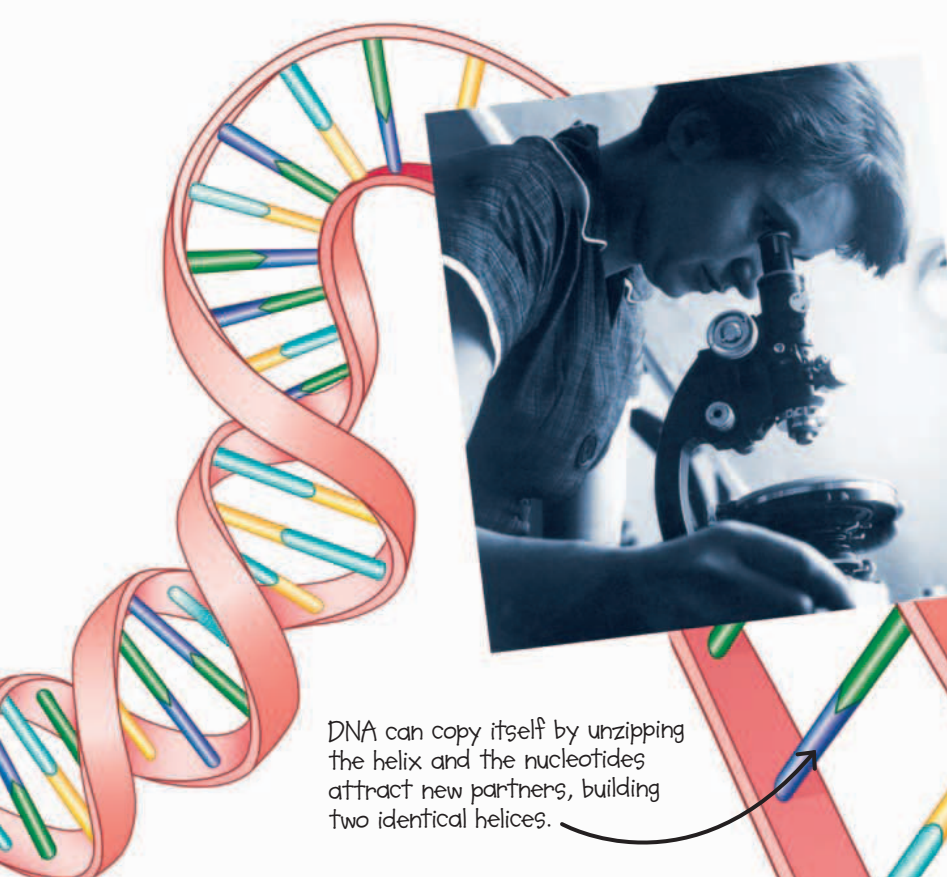




Credit where credit's due

At the same time as Watson and Crick, two scientists at King's College, London, **ROSALIND FRANKLIN** and Maurice Wilkins, were also studying DNA—using X-rays. Wilkins showed Watson a copy of Franklin's work without her permission. They used Franklin's findings in their research, but ***didn't give her the credit she deserved.*** Watson, Crick, and Wilkins all shared the **Nobel Prize for Medicine** in 1962, but Franklin received no acknowledgment for her contribution.

DNA can copy itself by unzipping the helix and the nucleotides attract new partners, building two identical helices.

Cracking the code of life

Deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) is the set of chemical instructions that ***lives in the cells of every creature on Earth.*** DNA tells a cell how to behave and grow. Watson and Crick discovered that DNA has two strands that are twisted together like a spiral ladder, called the **DOUBLE HELIX**. Between the strands are special molecules called nucleotides (which had been discovered already). There are **four different nucleotides** (Adenine, Thymine, Cytosine, and Guanine), and the order they are in determines the DNA's instructions.

Science from within

The discovery of DNA's structure opened up whole new branches of science. We can create genetically modified (GM) crops by fiddling with their DNA. Scientists have even mapped the genetic code of humans, which could lead to new cures for diseases, and even prevent them happening.

They paved the way for...



The police can **IDENTIFY A CRIMINAL** from the DNA he or she leaves behind. This is called **FORENSIC (OR GENETIC) FINGERPRINTING**.



Scientists can **CLONE** an animal by making a copy of its DNA. The first mammal ever cloned was **DOLLY THE SHEEP**, in 1996.